



Tears most of the day'

oast to coast, Americans turn to each other. 8A

TODAY

NO. 1 IN THE USA

Pentagon in flames

As many as 800 believed dead at military HQ. 7A

'Act of war'

Terrorists

irrendous'

Bush to nation:
U.S. 'saw evil'

Vows to avenge strikes. 1:58

Law enforcement
eyes bin Laden

Warrants in Florida

Crisis deepens
economic war

'The wrong time.' 11:58

86% say attacks
are acts of war

Is bin Laden still in the U.S.?



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Meet The EB

Letters from the Executive Board:

Greetings Delegates!



My name is Krish Aggarwal, and it is a great privilege to welcome you to the Ad hoc Committee for Inter SMUN 2026. I've always been a bit of a wild card, someone who embraces challenges and thrives in dynamic situations.

Currently, I am a 12th grader. Outside the classroom, I love playing football and chess. You'd often see me playing chess online or bothering my friends with the most unfunny jokes they've heard. When I'm not doing these things, I'd be playing golf or running on a track for hours on end.

I am and always have been a competitive person. From playing national-level chess to national-level bridge to national-level athletics, striving for perfection is something that's integrated into my nature. Sustainability is something that I have a soft spot for in my heart.

I started debating when I was in the third grade. I still remember how nervous I was before entering the room. The thrill of beating someone with arguments that I formulate on the spot is what made me fall in love with debating. I started my MUN journey pretty late, which made me realize that experience isn't everything. You can pull off something miraculous even if it's your first MUN ever!

In my opinion, a crisis committee requires quick thinking, creativity, and out-of-the-box solutions. You need to be able to adapt on the spot and counter arguments presented. Being in conferences has always been one of the most exhilarating things I do.

As a Director, I welcome you with open arms to this year's crisis committee of SMUN, and I can assure you that you will be thoroughly entertained!

Warm Regards,
Krish Aggarwal
Director

“Icarus laughed as he fell, for he knew to fall means to once have soared.”



Greetings, delegates,

It is my great honour to serve as your Director for the Ad hoc Committee at Sanskriti MUN 2026. My name is Manasvi Bhambani, and I am currently in Grade 12, pursuing a combination of Science and Economics.

I was first introduced to MUNs in 8th grade, where I found the invigorating world of speech and debate, where each word can be chastised and every action overturned. Through some sleepless nights and midnight meals at both national and international conferences, I have learned two things: always pack ramen in your suitcase, and the power of dialogue and diplomacy

Crisis committees hold a special place for me. They demand that you think on your feet and also be two steps ahead of everyone at all times. It is the only committee you'll see where deceit and contempt are welcomed with open arms. Crisis committees are anything but regular, from spy agencies running out of tailor shops to the creation of whole new nations based on movies; the sky is truly the limit.

Outside of MUNs, I enjoy cooking, cycling, and spending an unhealthy amount of time just watching movies and TV shows, my favourites being Brooklyn Nine-Nine, The Office, and The Dictator.

I urge you, delegates, to think beyond the obvious. The events of September 11th, 2001, must be approached not merely as history, but as a nexus that reshaped global prejudice, policy, and power structures in ways that continue to unfold.

Until April,
Manasvi Bhambani
Director



Greetings delegates,

My name is Raaga Varunika, and it is a great privilege to serve as your additional director for the ad-hoc committee in InterSMUN 2026. I have always believed in balancing a variety of interests and finding value in the diversity of experiences.

I am currently in grade 11, studying science. I've grown up playing various sports, including tennis, gymnastics, and track, and playing the piano. I am very competitive, so I started participating in Model United Nations to gain a global perspective, which unfolded through an unforgettable journey of conferences and trips. Throughout my life, I've chased awards and accolades, but MUNs have taught me that advocating for those without a voice is a much better victory.

My love for sports stemmed from how much I loved the feeling of adrenaline, and the crisis committee is a perfect blend of chaos and diplomacy. Outside of the court and conference halls, I've always had a soft spot for physics and literature, two subjects that taught me nothing is out of limits

Sanskriti School has always been a constant throughout my life, so to be able to be a part of SMUN is an absolute dream. One thing about crisis committees is that it is a battle of wits. There is no such thing as a bad starting position. Nothing is permanent if you try hard enough.

Ad-hoc will require you to stretch the bounds of your imagination and problem-solving skills, but I assure you it will be worth it.

Regards,

Raaga Varunika Chaudhary

Additional Director

“Filled with the terror of becoming prey. See how quickly we become predators?”

-Professor Volumnia Gaul, The Ballad of Songbirds and Snakes



Greetings Delegates!

It is my honour to serve as your Additional Director for the Ad Hoc Crisis Committee of Sanskriti MUN 2026. My name is Savya Karri, and I study in 11th with a combination of Science and Economics.

I hold an interest in multiple fields, from physics and maths to political science and history. On my Spotify, you can find me replaying Blonde, The College Dropout, and IGOR, among others. I'm also an amateur cinephile, having finally made my Letterboxd account active again.

My journey at SMUN has been exhilarating, to say the least. I started crisis in 8th grade, where I walked into committee with about 2 pages of handwritten research and no foresight into what I was signing up for. From winning my first award to winning my last, crisis has made me more spontaneous and helped me truly excel in the arts of expression. To me, it is a medium of creativity, from hypnotising someone with shamans to kidnapping sitting presidents, you need something truly innate to survive in this committee room.

Fast forward to today, where I find myself on the other side of the table with a gavel in my hand, I hope to provide these same experiences to you.

The beauty of this committee is the power that delegates hold in their pens, and how quickly committee *turncoats* with a single update. Reflect, and use this power wisely.

Signed

Savya Karri

Additional Director

Greetings delegates!



My name is Eira Jha, and it is my great honour to serve as your additional director for the Ad-Hoc committee at INTERSMUN 2026. Currently, I am studying humanities with economics in the 11th grade.

My MUN journey began as a clueless 12-year-old who barely knew the full form of GSL. If you're walking into this committee confused or overwhelmed, welcome. This feeling is one that I'm quite familiar with, and I assure you, it will fade quickly. I always have and always will be a crisis delegate, and to me, every conference began as something scary, but ended as a room where I felt the most comfortable. Crisis committees demand creative approaches (and also a lot of writing), and perhaps unsurprisingly, my love for the How to Train Your Dragon franchise and the occasional binge-watch of a classic zombie show has led me to wholeheartedly enjoy the more unconventional and militarised side of crisis, where chaos is inevitable, and logic turns into a weapon.

Delegates, the responsibility now lies with you. Which weapon will you ultimately choose to wield?

Best regards,
Eira Jha
Additional Director

Timeline Overview

Timeline Overview (1993-2001):

- **1993:** In February 1993, a truck bomb detonated beneath the World Trade Centre in New York City. This attack was aimed to destabilise US infrastructure and cause mass casualties. Linked to operatives belonging to transnational networks, it resulted in six deaths and more than 1,000 injuries. This attack demonstrated a new power in the hands of non-state actors allowing them to conduct attacks on a large-scale on US soil.
- **1996-98:** During this period, Al Qaeda, headed by Osama bin Laden significantly expanded its outreach in terms of operation and ideology. Post concentration of Taliban power in Afghanistan, terrorist groups were easily able to establish proper training camps and bases with ease. In the years of 1996 & 1998, bin Laden globally issued formal declarations advocating for attacks on the US military and civilian population. This also indirectly exposed the limited coordination between the Central Intelligence Agency and law enforcement agencies.
- **1998:** In August 1998, embassies in Nairobi and Dar es Salaam were bombed, resulting in over 200 fatalities and thousands of injured civilians. In response, the United States conducted missile strikes, attacking suspected terrorist facilities in Afghanistan and Sudan. The year 1998 is considered to be a turning point for the increase in importance and priority of counterterrorism in US foreign policy and security.
- **2000:** In October, the USS Cole was attacked through a suicide bombing during refueling at Aden, Yemen. This led to the deaths of 17 naval personnel and severely damaged the ship. It demonstrated the coming of a new, non-traditional form of warfare, particularly through the use of suicide attacks on military assets.
- **January 2001:** George W. Bush takes office in the midst of political and economic uncertainty
- **September 11, 2001:** Coordinated terrorist attacks on the United States
 - **September 20, 2001:** Presidential address to Congress, declaration of global war on terror

Historical Perspective

The United States after the Cold War:

The Cold War (1947-91) led to numerous groundbreaking transformations as the world made its way to the 21st century. With the end of the greatest and perhaps most defining rivalry of the 20th century, it soon became clear that there was now only one superpower, the United States of America. This unipolar moment marked the single, unrivaled power that was capable of shaping a new world order.

Whether it be in terms of economy, creating the largest financial system centered around its own currency, leading the establishment of global enterprises and organisations, or its extensive and unparalleled military might, the United States shifted smoothly from the key defence of the 'Free World' to the unequivocal hegemony of a new, liberal international set-up, guiding the visions, policies and interventions throughout the 1990s.

Emergence as the International Superpower:

With the collapse of the Soviet Union post-Cold War, the global balance of power changed. The United States, now faced no rival, and emerged as the sole international power. Notable political analysts such as Charles Krauthammer coined this initiation as the 'Unipolar Movement'. This was the first time post the monarchical era that this had occurred. The world may have seen multipolar and bipolar powers, but during this movement, there was not one entity that could challenge the might of the United States' economy, military, or polity.

The United States also established its supremacy through leadership in international institutions such as the United Nations, North Atlantic Treaty Organisation (NATO), International Monetary Fund (IMF), and the World Bank, which increasingly began operating under American leadership. Thus, the previous landscape of the 'Free World' (US and Western Europe, alliances) now expanded to a broader picture of global stability and world order. Due to the clear dominance of American influence in the institutional landscape, the United States was now able to exercise power without coercive capability.

However, this emergence was also heavily reliant on the strong integration of capabilities and opportunities of the post-Cold War environment. With unrivaled technological capability, immense market influence, and a large diplomatic reach, the United States, in all possible arenas, was the sole leader.

Global military, economic, and political dominance:

To sustain its global dominance, the United States had to consistently hold its advances across all domains: political, economic, and military.

On the military front, the United States' defence capabilities and reach have remained unparalleled. Post the Cold War, the United States defence budget grew quickly, to the equivalent of the combination of the budgets of the next nine-ten nations. The military dominance was expressed evidently in the Gulf War (1991), which became a key interpreter for American dominance in the new unipolar world. Following the Iraqi invasion of Kuwait led by dictator Saddam Hussein in August 1990, Operation Desert Shield was launched, wherein troops were stationed to defend the United Arab Emirates & its interests. However, when diplomatic persuasion to push Iraqi withdrawal failed, the United States and its 35-allied nations launched Operation Desert Storm on January 17, 1991. This eventually led to the defeat of Iraqi forces, thus strengthening the idea of American supremacy when it came to the militia.

Beyond large-scale interventions, the American military also consistently held stations across Europe, East Asia, the Middle East, and some regions of Africa. Hence, the United States acted as a first responder in case of crises, while also reinforcing leadership in organisations like NATO, which later expanded to include former Warsaw Pact nations as well. The US was also involved in stabilisation efforts in Bosnia and Kosovo. This illustrated its crucial role in managing post-Cold War challenges.

Economically, the main drive for American dominance was the US Dollar. In the 1990s, the dollar functioned as the primary reserve currency, accounting for 47.14% of total global foreign exchange reserves. US financial markets, particularly Treasury securities, which are debt obligations issued by the US Department of the Treasury, became the focal point for global capital. This gave Washington great leverage over international economic situations, particularly in Eastern Europe post Cold-War.

A key approach in the United States' multi-pronged approach to bringing global change was sculpted through the "Third" globalisation post-1980, wherein they played a crucial role in shaping the rules of the new digital era through institutions such as the International Monetary Fund (IMF), the World Bank, and later the World Trade Organisation through which the General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade (GATT) was replaced with a stricter system with regard to global trade, intellectual property and service liberalisation. With the coming of the North American Trade Agreement in 1994, the United States, Mexico, and Canada created a free-trade zone, where most barriers were eliminated, and regional economies were integrated into a larger, structured system that was largely shaped by American norms and interests.

Beyond the economy and military, the United States tied all its efforts to its international political power. This political dominance was fostered through the frequent use of its ability to mediate within conflicts, with a notable presence in the General Framework Agreement (1995). Widely known as the Dayton Accords, it established the complex political structure of Bosnia and Herzegovina (BiH), in which two entities (the Federation of BiH and Republika Srpska) shared a single state. Within popular global forums such as the United Nations Security Council and the G7 (Canada, France, Germany, Italy, Japan, the United Kingdom, and the US), American influence led the UNSC to establish the initiation of fourteen sanction regimes in the 1990s. The United States also mobilised political support through the coming of ideological change in post-Communist Europe. The growing support for democratic governance and liberalism with respect to Western institutions also heightened American influence in a new, liberal world order.



A New World Order:

Through economic, military, and diplomatic methods, the United States established itself as the sole superpower in the world and set out to impose upon other nations its new World Order, centred on liberal ideals, free markets, and a keen focus on US interests. With this turn in the political state of the world, a lot of changes took place.

- Organisations like the UN, International Monetary Fund, WHO, etc., expanded their control and powers under the umbrella of the US. With a singular global power backing them, international communication and globalisation cemented themselves as the management system of the world. With the liberalisation of the world, conflicts and issues have emerged as a global issue to be solved with cooperation, limiting the probability of wars occurring without prior tries at diplomacy and negotiation. With its permanent UN Security Council seat and veto power, the US established a hegemony over all decisions. Thus, the US was able to shape its political interests in the world.
- Complementing this, Latin America and other developing regions of the world faced an influx of trade and commerce, helping to develop their economies and nations. Sans the concerns of tariff wars and economic conflicts, the world's markets opened up, and the United States established itself as a powerhouse of manufacturing and export.
- Championing the cause for democratic ideals, the United States continued its Cold War policy of defending capitalistic interests, albeit modified it. It gave itself the moral right to police the world and purge it from any evils.

However, there were also negative impacts to this unitary world,

- The rise of US power led to direct anti - US backlash. Specifically from Russia, China, and various powers in the Middle East, which all sought to dismantle the United States from its throne. So the US developed ideological rivals around the world, radicalising many groups. The United States was perceived as “ imperialist “, creating resentment. Erosion of state sovereignty in the name of protecting vested interests was often justified in the name of humanitarian or security interests.
- A dependence on US leadership led to many states becoming totally reliant on American help. These include numerous microstates in the Pacific, such as the Marshall Islands, Palau, Micronesia, and also bigger countries that needed protection by the army, such as South Korea, Japan, Taiwan, and Israel. All of these countries served to further US hold in respective regions, sacrificing their freedoms.
- The economic benefits of globalization often did not reach all countries, leaving many in destitution. The unequal distribution of development caused social unrest and increased inequality and corruption in regions, leaving them in worse states than before.

Counter Terrorism Frameworks

Until September 11, 2001, the United States had limited experience with terrorist attacks on its own soil and only intermittent experience with attacks overseas. During the 1970s and 80s, airline hijackings and overseas bombings were the focus of most terrorist activity. In 1993, violent Islamist extremists bombed the World Trade Center, causing six deaths and more than a thousand injuries, but failing to significantly damage the structures themselves. During the next decade, several domestic focused Islamist terrorist plots were foiled at the planning stage; however, additional attacks were conducted overseas, by operatives of Hezbollah killing US service personnel in 1996 at the Khobar Towers complex in Saudi Arabia, by al Qaeda bombing of US embassies in East Africa in 1998, and the attack on the USS Cole near Yemen in 2000. The most deadly attack domestically during the 1990s was the Oklahoma City bombing, carried out by Timothy McVeigh, an anti-government extremist. So Counter Terrorism Frameworks were being developed in the United States from the 1970s, after the infamous Munich massacre.

The preexisting institutes that exist are:

- The **Illegal Immigration Reform and Immigrant Responsibility Act of 1996 (IIRAIRA)**: signed on September 30, 1996, it significantly tightened U.S. immigration laws by enhancing border enforcement, intensifying penalties for illegal entry, and mandating detention for many undocumented immigrants, including those with minor criminal records. It established three and ten-year bars on reentry for unlawful presence and expedited removal processes
- The **Antiterrorism and Effective Death Penalty Act of 1996 (AEDPA)**: a major U.S. federal law enacted on April 24, 1996, in response to the 1995 Oklahoma City bombing to combat domestic

terrorism and accelerate capital punishment appeals. The legislation aimed to streamline the appeals process for inmates on death row, significantly reducing the success rate of federal habeas petitions by inmates. The Act imposed a one-year statute of limitations for filing federal habeas petitions and mandated that state prisoners exhaust all state-level remedies first. It restricted federal courts from granting relief unless the state court's decision was "contrary to, or involved an unreasonable application of, clearly established Federal law".

- **Executive Order 12947 (1995)**: issued by President Bill Clinton, was a landmark, targeted sanction order aimed at disrupting the financial support network of foreign terrorist groups attempting to undermine the Middle East peace process. It declared a national emergency and authorized the Secretary of the Treasury to block all assets within the U.S. or under the control of U.S. persons belonging to "Specially Designated Terrorists" (SDTs).
- **Foreign Intelligence Surveillance Act (FISA), 1978**: a U.S. federal law that sets procedures for government surveillance and intelligence gathering for foreign threats, establishing the special Foreign Intelligence Surveillance Court (FISC) to authorize warrants for electronic surveillance, physical searches, and business records concerning foreign powers or agents, balancing national security with Fourth Amendment rights
- **Omnibus Diplomatic Security and Antiterrorism Act, 1986**

Post 9/11, throughout that small window, multiple orders were executed, the most relevant being:

- **National Emergency Declaration** - 14 Sept 2001
- **Authorization for Use of Military Force (AUMF)** – 18 Sept 2001. This gave the President authority to use “**all necessary and appropriate force**” and granted the President authority to use all “necessary and appropriate force” against nations, organizations, or persons involved in the 9/11 attacks. It was designed to prevent future acts of international terrorism against the U.S
- **NATO Article 5** – Invoked 12 Sept 2001
- **United Nations Security Council Resolution 1368** – 12 Sept 2001, this recognised the US right to self-defence and condemned terrorism.

Apart from laws, multiple institutions were also established that streamlined the process of counter terrorism itself. These include:

- **Central Intelligence Agency**:- Created through the National Security Act (NSA) of 1947 for peacetime intelligence.
- **Federal Bureau of Investigation**: This was primarily seen as a neutralizing force in America during the Civil Rights Movement and followed the COINTELPRO initiative (J Edgar Hoover)
- **Department of Defense (DoD)** - helped in its key role of centralising the fight against terrorism

Early Priorities of the Bush Administration

The early priorities of the George W. Bush administration (starting in 2001) centered on a major tax cut (\$1.35 trillion passed in June 2001), education reform via the No Child Left Behind Act, strengthening the military, and implementing faith-based initiatives. Post-9/11, focus immediately shifted to homeland security, enacting the Patriot Act, and initiating the War on Terror.

The Bush Administration declared the following policies (5.1)

1. Protecting Homeland Security
2. Energy Security for the 21st Century
3. Tax Relief
4. Judicial Nominations
5. Fighting the global war on terror
6. Renewal In Iraq

The Bush administration's responses to the terrorist attacks of September 11, 2001, expanded presidential power in matters of national security. Bush transformed from being a President with questionable legitimacy, who had been selected in a controversial election, to taking on immense presidential emergency powers, defining the threat, and attacking the enemy. His administration justified its actions by citing Article II of the U.S. Constitution that outlines the powers of the President as commander in chief, as well as legal authorizations passed by Congress. Following 9/11, Bush's leadership became a rallying point for the nation. (5.2) His policies directly affected life in the US before and after the 9/11 attacks; they were a significant rallying point for the citizens of America.

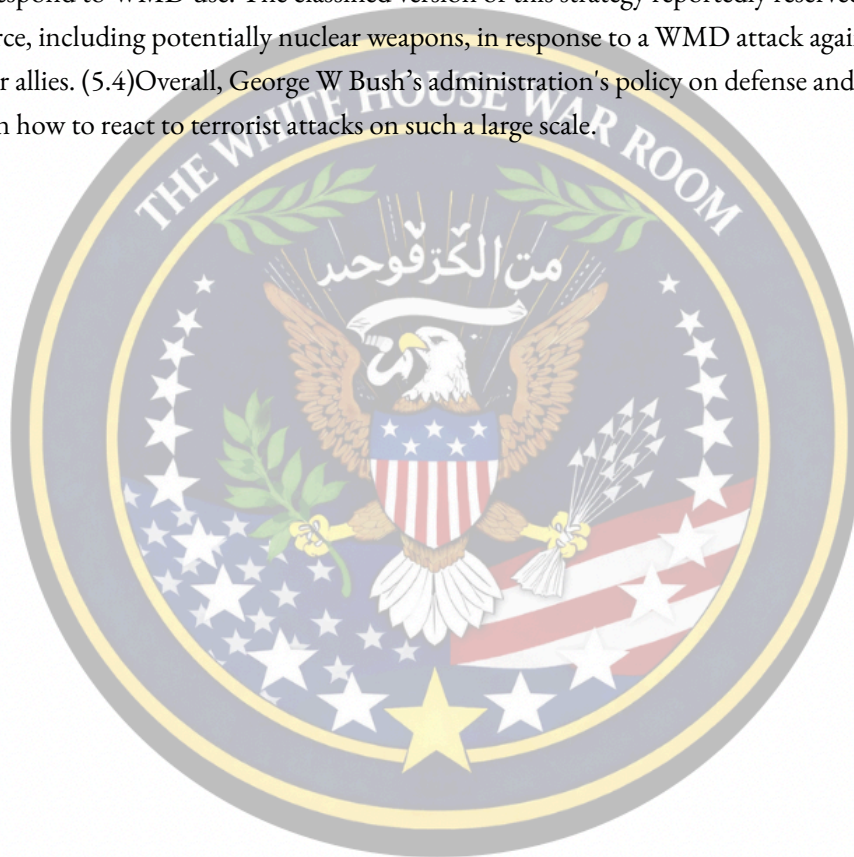
Foreign Policy

With the end of the Cold War, the Bush foreign policy team faced such radical and rapid global changes that the Department of State seemed capable only of reacting to events. The collapse of first the Soviet bloc in Eastern Europe and then the Soviet Union itself, the reunification of Germany, the end of apartheid in South Africa, pro-democracy demonstrations in China's Tiananmen Square, the international coalition formed to combat Iraq's Saddam Hussein in the Middle East stretched the ability of the U.S. foreign policy establishment, from the President to the Department of State, to stay in front of events and formulate policy. (5.3)

Bush's own active involvement and direct communications with foreign leaders surprised many career officers at the Department, and not everyone was comfortable with informal lines of communication. Vernon Walters, the

U.S. Ambassador to the Federal Republic of Germany, reportedly resigned in part due to frustration after continuously hearing second-hand reports from the West German Foreign Ministry of agreements reached independently by Bush and Chancellor Helmut Kohl. (5.3)

The Bush administration released its "National Strategy to Combat Weapons of Mass Destruction" in December 2002. The strategy includes three key elements: counterproliferation to combat the use of Weapons of Mass Destruction (WMD), strengthened nonproliferation to combat WMD proliferation, and consequence management to respond to WMD use. The classified version of this strategy reportedly reserved the right to use overwhelming force, including potentially nuclear weapons, in response to a WMD attack against the United States, its forces or allies. (5.4) Overall, George W Bush's administration's policy on defense and foreign policy set the global stage on how to react to terrorist attacks on such a large scale.





Chronological Order:

Intelligence Warnings:

Before the Al Qaeda attacks in 2001, a string of intelligence warnings was transmitted around the globe. On March 23, members of the commission investigating the Sept. 11 attacks said on Tuesday that a series of intelligence reports sent to President Bush in 2001 warned of an imminent, possibly catastrophic attack by Al Qaeda. The disclosure prompted harsh questioning of Defense Secretary Donald H. Rumsfeld and other administration officials about why they had not done more to pre-empt a possible terrorist strike. (5.1)

The Clinton administration's counterterrorism policies were also the subject of sharp questioning at a hearing of the panel, with former Secretary of State Madeleine K. Albright and former Defense Secretary William S. Cohen asked to explain why their colleagues had failed to eliminate the Qaeda network and take Osama bin Laden into custody. (5.1) After the attacks, the 23-member panel began questioning the entire Bush administration on how such a destructive attack could have happened without any earlier signs or warnings. Both Democrats and Republicans had the same questions on how exactly this could have gone ignored. But the harsher questioning, from Democrats and Republicans alike, was reserved for Mr. Rumsfeld, especially after he and Secretary of State Colin L. Powell acknowledged in testimony that they had been aware of intelligence reports in 2001 warning of the especially dire terrorist threat against the United States. (5.1) Mr. Rumsfeld and Colin L. Powell were discussed and questioned in detail when it came to uncovering the roots of the operation. The 10-member bipartisan commission is in the final weeks of its investigation. And though the panel has held other hearings in recent months, the questioning on Tuesday of four top officials of the Bush and Clinton administrations offered the most exhaustive public examination of diplomatic and military failures in the years before Sept. 11. (5.1)

The administration and intelligence community appear to have made serious mistakes in the weeks before the attacks. The Bush administration believed Al Qaeda might resort to hijacking only in the traditional sense, seizing an airplane and treating its passengers as hostages for bargaining purposes. But the idea that Al Qaeda would engage in only a traditional hijacking should have been seen as doubtful. Well before Sept. 11, we knew that Al Qaeda and its affiliates were not traditional terrorists. Their record showed that they would try to kill as many Americans as possible using whatever new tactics they could devise. (5.2) Some intelligence officials felt their warnings were not taken seriously enough, with CIA officials becoming "apoplectic" as summer progressed.

The Bush administration could not have known the magnitude and scale of the 9/11 attacks as specified in numerous articles and insider sources, but they did have access to an array of information.

Qaeda and Islamic extremists had already tried to destroy the World Trade Center towers in 1993. Sheik Omar Abdel Rahman and others had designs to destroy infrastructure like New York's Lincoln Tunnel. Qaeda terrorists had killed hundreds in the 1998 attacks against American embassies in Kenya and Tanzania. On the eve of the millennium, an operative linked to Osama bin Laden, Ahmed Ressam, tried to sneak into the United States to bomb Los Angeles International Airport. And a Qaeda affiliate, Ramzi Yousef, had developed plans to

blow up a dozen American jumbo jets in the mid-1990's. By the late 1990s, intelligence services should have recognized that Qaeda hijackers would be likely to kill everyone on board any plane they seized. (5.2)

Furthermore, by May of 2001, says Cofer Black, then chief of the CIA's counterterrorism center, "it was very evident that we were going to be struck, we were gonna be struck hard, and lots of Americans were going to die." "There were real plots being manifested," Cofer's former boss, George Tenet, told me in his first interview in eight years. "The world felt like it was on the edge of eruption"(5.3). The drama of failed warnings began when Tenet and Black pitched a plan, in the spring of 2001, called "the Blue Sky paper" to Bush's new national security team. It called for a covert CIA and military campaign to end the Al Qaeda threat, "getting into the Afghan sanctuary, launching a paramilitary operation, creating a bridge with Uzbekistan."(5.3)

The Bush administration had access to a cohort of information, tips, and sources, and knew a terrorist attack was to happen. But to truly uncover the sheer scale of the attack was impossible.

Some important dates and events in which we can track the different intelligence warnings are:

1. **March 2001**- Italian intelligence warned of an Al-Qaeda plot involving a massive strike using an aircraft.
2. **Spring 2001** - CIA officials had been briefed on "Blue sky" by a new national security team, which had been a plan to target Al-Qaeda; further information on this has not been mentioned since the administration was not quite ready to consider it.
3. **July 2001**- Jordanian intelligence warned of an imminent attack on American soil, 20 Al- Qaeda jihadists had been reported, some of whom were flight school trainees.
4. **July 26th**- Attorney General Ashcroft stopped flying commercial airlines due to threat assessments.
5. **August 6th** - President Bush received PDB, " Bin Laden Determined to Strike in US", warning of hijackings and surveillance of federal buildings.
6. **Later in August 2001**- Israeli Mossad warned of a major impending attack and provided a list of potential operatives in the US.

Contested Presidential elections of 2001:

The Bush VS Gore elections were highly controversial - a heavily contested and close election.

After a mistaken television network's projections on election night leading to a concession call by Al Gore to George W. Bush that was withdrawn an hour later, and the ensuing 36-day political and legal war over how to resolve what was essentially a tie, Bush ultimately garnered the presidency when a sharply divided and transparently political Supreme Court ended the manual recount in Florida that might have produced a different outcome. It was the closest presidential election in American history, with only several hundred votes in Florida determining the winner out of more than 100 million ballots cast nationwide. (6.1)

George W. Bush moves to the White House under the most inauspicious of circumstances. He is the first president to lose the national popular vote since 1888, and only the fourth in American history. He won a bare majority in the electoral college, and only because of his contested victory in Florida, where the best evidence suggests that flawed ballot designs, confused voters, and antiquated voting equipment kept the plurality of citizens who intended to support Gore from having their verdict reflected in the official count. (6.1)

In his presidential campaign, Bush had denounced foreign nation-building; he populated his administration with neoconservatives, firm believers in the expansion of American democracy and American interests abroad. Bush advanced what was sometimes called the Bush Doctrine, a policy in which the United States would have the right to unilaterally and preemptively make war on any regime or terrorist organization that posed a threat to the United States or to U.S. citizens. It would lead the United States into protracted conflicts in Afghanistan and Iraq and entangle the United States in nations across the world. Journalist Dexter Filkins called it a Forever War, a perpetual conflict waged against an amorphous and undefeatable enemy. The geopolitical realities of the twenty-first-century world were forever transformed. (6.2)

The election's controversial nature also stems from conspiracies on whether 9/11 would have happened had Bush not taken office, considering his administration ignored a large amount of intelligence warnings and his stark geopolitical views and ideologies.

In addition to the warnings already mentioned, there were several other signals within the intelligence community that suggested a major terrorist operation was developing. These warnings came from different agencies and different countries. Many of them did not describe the exact form of the attack, but they showed that Al Qaeda was planning something significant.

One of the most important warnings came from inside the United States itself. In July 2001, an FBI agent in Arizona named Kenneth Williams sent a memo to FBI headquarters. This document later became known as the "Phoenix Memo." In it, he warned that a number of individuals connected to radical Islamic groups were attending flight schools in the United States. He suggested that Osama bin Laden might be sending followers to

American aviation schools so they could gain knowledge of aircraft systems. Williams recommended that the FBI create a list of foreign students at flight schools and investigate them more closely. Unfortunately, the memo did not receive urgent attention in Washington, and no nationwide investigation was started at that time.

Another critical event occurred in August 2001 when a French Moroccan student named Zacarias Moussaoui was arrested in Minnesota. Moussaoui had been taking lessons at a flight school, but instructors became suspicious because he showed little interest in learning how to land the plane. He mainly wanted to understand how to control large commercial aircraft while in the air. The instructors reported him to the FBI, and he was arrested for immigration violations. Local FBI agents believed he might be planning to hijack an airplane and asked headquarters for permission to search his laptop and belongings. The request was denied because officials believed there was not enough legal evidence linking him to terrorism. After the attacks, investigators discovered that Moussaoui had connections to Al Qaeda operatives.

Intelligence agencies were also detecting a large increase in what they called “threat chatter.” This term refers to communications between extremist groups that suggest preparations for an attack. During the summer of 2001, the National Security Agency intercepted several messages connected to Al Qaeda networks. Some of these communications contained vague statements such as “the match is about to begin” and “the big event is coming.” While these messages did not give details about a target or date, they indicated that an operation was approaching.

There were also serious gaps in intelligence coordination. Two future hijackers named Khalid al Mihdhar and Nawaf al Hazmi, had already been identified by US intelligence during an Al Qaeda meeting in Kuala Lumpur in January 2000. The CIA knew that both men had visas to enter the United States. However, this information was not quickly shared with the FBI or immigration authorities. Because of this failure, the two men entered the United States and lived openly in California for more than a year before the attacks. If their names had been placed on watchlists earlier, they might have been stopped when they arrived in the country.

Warnings were also circulating in the aviation sector. In the months before September 2001, the Federal Aviation Administration issued several internal bulletins to airlines and airports. These notices warned of the possibility of terrorist hijackings linked to Osama bin Laden. Security officials were advised to be alert for suspicious passengers or unusual behavior. However, most planning still assumed that hijackers would follow older patterns where terrorists took control of a plane and demanded negotiations or ransom. The idea that attackers would deliberately crash airplanes into buildings was not widely considered in official planning.

Military defense systems were also designed around older hijacking scenarios. The North American Aerospace Defense Command had procedures to intercept aircraft if pilots lost communication or if a plane strayed from its flight path. These procedures expected that hijacked planes would still be flying toward airports or negotiating with authorities. The possibility that a hijacked plane would immediately be used as a weapon inside American airspace was not a major focus of training exercises before 2001.

During the summer of 2001, senior intelligence officials repeatedly warned government leaders that the threat environment was extremely dangerous. CIA Director George Tenet later said that the level of alarm inside the intelligence community was higher than it had been in years. Daily intelligence briefings described possible attacks on American interests around the world. Many officials believed an attack was likely, but they did not know when it would happen or where the target would be.

Taken together, these warnings show that there were many fragments of information scattered across agencies and countries. Each piece by itself seemed incomplete or uncertain. The main problem was that the pieces were not fully connected. Analysts did not see the entire pattern until after the attacks occurred. The investigations that followed concluded that intelligence agencies had many clues but lacked coordination, information sharing, and imagination about how terrorists might use airplanes as weapons.

After the events of September 11, the consequences were not limited to the United States. The event reshaped global politics, security policies, international relations, and military strategies. Governments across the world began to reconsider how terrorism should be handled and how intelligence cooperation should work. Several major global implications emerged from these attacks.

2. Changes in International Security Policies

After the attacks, many countries dramatically strengthened their national security policies. Governments expanded intelligence surveillance programs and passed new counterterrorism laws. Airports, borders, and major public infrastructure became far more heavily monitored.

Air travel security changed the most. Screening procedures became stricter across the world. Passenger identification systems were improved, and many countries began sharing airline passenger information with intelligence agencies. Cockpit doors on commercial aircraft were reinforced to prevent hijackers from entering them. These measures were introduced because the attacks demonstrated how civilian aircraft could be used as weapons.

3. Growth of International Intelligence Cooperation

Another major implication was the expansion of intelligence sharing between countries. Before 2001, intelligence agencies often worked independently, and information sharing was limited. The attacks demonstrated that terrorist networks operate across many countries and that intelligence must be coordinated internationally.

Organizations such as NATO increased cooperation on counterterrorism operations. For the first time in its history, NATO invoked Article 5 of its treaty, which states that an attack on one member is considered an attack on all members. Intelligence agencies from Europe, Asia, and the Middle East began working more closely with American agencies to track terrorist networks.

4. New Military Conflicts and Geopolitical Changes

The attacks also triggered long-term geopolitical consequences. The war in Afghanistan eventually expanded into a broader international military presence in the region. Several NATO countries contributed troops to stabilize Afghanistan and fight extremist groups.

5. Economic Consequences

The attacks also had significant global economic effects. Financial markets around the world reacted immediately with uncertainty. Stock markets temporarily closed in the United States, and global trade slowed for a short period. Industries such as aviation, tourism, and insurance suffered major losses because people became more cautious about travel.

Governments also increased spending on security and defense. Large amounts of money were invested in surveillance systems, intelligence agencies, and military operations. This shift changed national budgets in many countries because security spending became a much higher priority.

6. Social and Cultural Impact

The attacks also affected societies around the world. Public awareness of terrorism increased significantly, and security concerns became part of everyday life. Many countries experienced debates about civil liberties, privacy, and the balance between freedom and security.

There were also social consequences, such as increased suspicion and discrimination against certain communities, especially Muslims and people of Middle Eastern background. Governments and international organizations later worked to address these tensions and emphasize that terrorism should not be associated with any single religion or community.

7. Long-Term Changes in Counterterrorism Strategy

Finally, the attacks transformed how governments think about terrorism. Before 2001, many countries treated terrorist attacks as isolated events carried out by small groups. After 9/11, it became clear that terrorist networks could operate globally and coordinate complex attacks.

As a result, counterterrorism strategies began focusing on prevention, intelligence analysis, financial tracking, and international cooperation. Governments also invested in cyber surveillance and advanced technologies to monitor extremist communication networks.

Overall, the global implications of the September 11 attacks were enormous. The event reshaped military strategy, international alliances, national security policies, and public awareness of terrorism. Even decades later, many of the security systems and political strategies introduced after the attacks continue to influence global affairs.



National and International Impact of the 9/11 Attacks:

International Reactions to the Attacks:

The September 11, 2001, attacks led to an extraordinary showcase of cross-country cooperation. Widely known as the most deadly terrorist attack, it resulted not only in the loss of approximately 3,000 lives but also reshaped the global situation in terms of security priorities, political discussion, and economic stability across the globe. In its immediate aftermath, governments, institutions, and citizens responded in ways showcasing a sense of unity with the United States as well as an increasing recognition of the new global threat that is transnational terrorism.

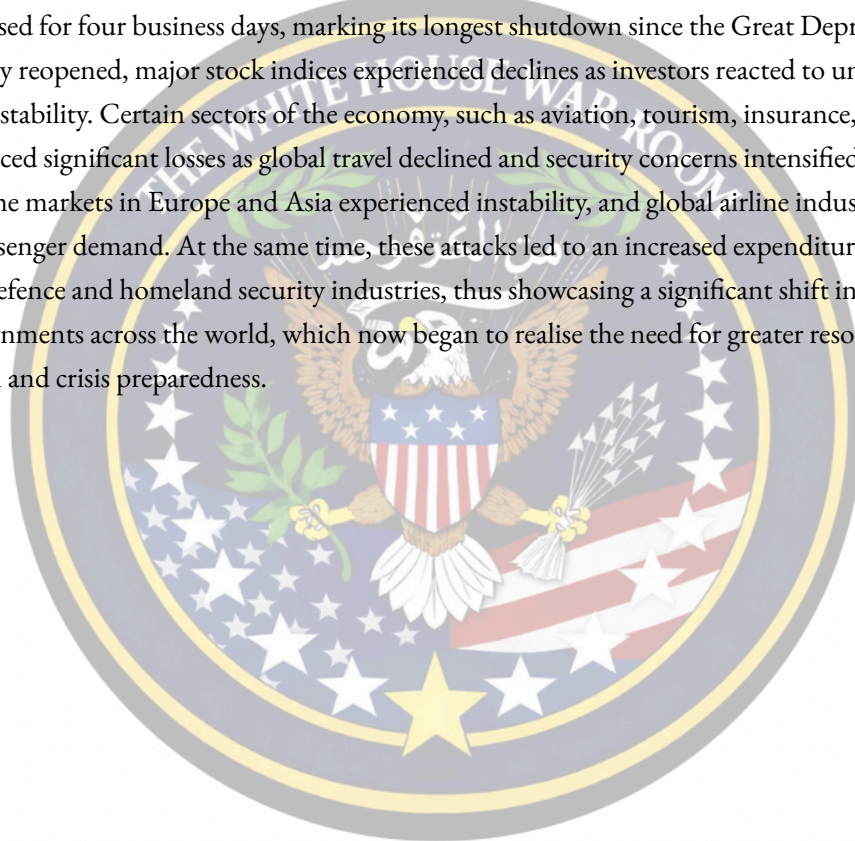
On the international front, reactions to the attacks were mainly characterised by immense diplomatic support for the United States. Several world leaders, such as UK Prime Minister Tony Blair, Russian President Vladimir Putin, German Chancellor Gerhard Schröder, and French President Jacques Chirac, publicly condemned the attacks, offering support and condolences. One of the most notable responses to the attacks was by the North Atlantic Treaty Organisation (NATO), wherein Article 5 of their founding treaty was invoked. This, for the first time in their history, declared that an armed attack against one member would be considered an attack against all its members. This collective defense clause showed how united the world was in response to the attacks. Later, this gave rise to a political framework for multinational military action in Afghanistan. Beyond NATO, other organizations like the United Nations Security Council (UNSC) also passed resolutions that condemned terrorism and urged states to work together more on counter-terrorism efforts. Even countries that had previously had tense relations with the US, such as Russia and China, expressed their support regarding global counterterrorism initiatives.

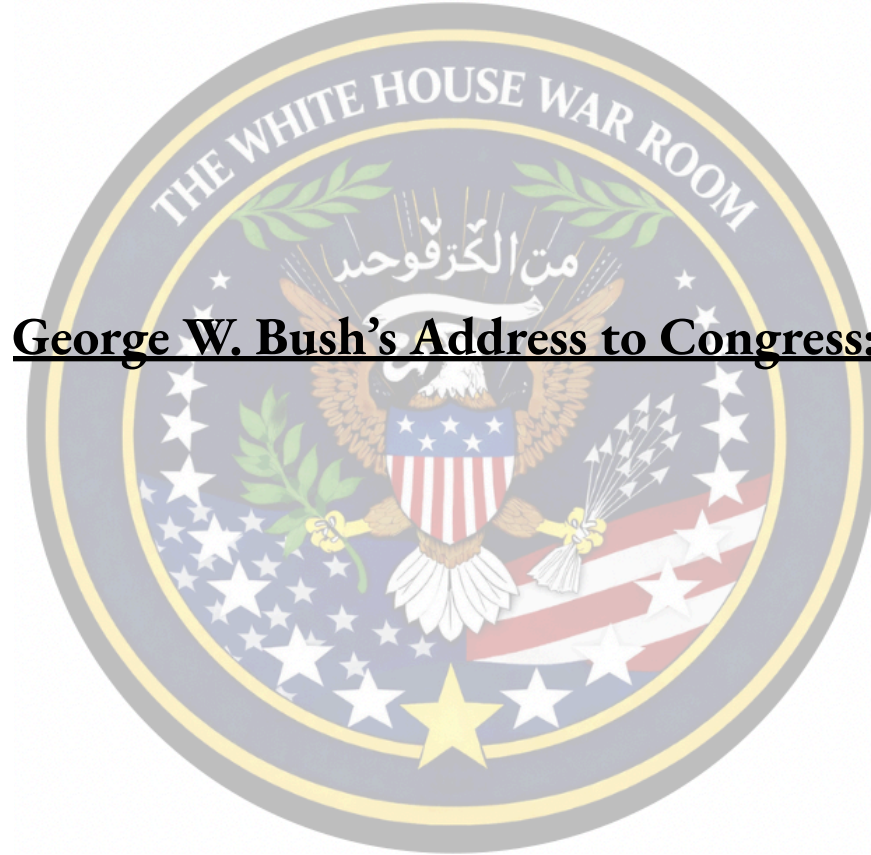
National Political and Social Situation:

Within the United States, civilian and political situations showcased a profound sense of national unity and grief. Citizens participated in memorial services, volunteer efforts, and national movements for remembrance. At the same time, members of Congress from both Democratic and Republican parties expressed support for decisive action against those who were responsible for the attacks. This led to the passage of a joint resolution, the Authorisation for Use of Military Force (AUMF) in September 2001, which authorised the President to target nations, organisations, or persons involved in the September 11, 2001, terrorist attacks. Following this, the United States government enacted the USA Patriot Act (Uniting and Strengthening America by Providing Appropriate Tools Required to Intercept and Obstruct Terrorism Act) in October 2001. This led to a significant increase in American law enforcement's surveillance and investigative powers in order to combat terrorism. These measures initially enjoyed popular support from citizens due to fear and a need for protection, but eventually led to intense debates on the balance between national security and civil liberties. This set up the backdrop for political discourse in the United States in the coming years.

Economic impact:

Economically, the attacks led to immediate disruptions in the United States as well as the global financial system. In the days following the attacks, American financial markets were temporarily closed, and the New York Stock Exchange was closed for four business days, marking its longest shutdown since the Great Depression. When markets eventually reopened, major stock indices experienced declines as investors reacted to uncertainty and fears of further instability. Certain sectors of the economy, such as aviation, tourism, insurance, and transportation, faced significant losses as global travel declined and security concerns intensified. Internationally, the markets in Europe and Asia experienced instability, and global airline industries also faced a sharp drop in passenger demand. At the same time, these attacks led to an increased expenditure by the government on defence and homeland security industries, thus showcasing a significant shift in economic priorities in governments across the world, which now began to realise the need for greater resources towards counter terrorism and crisis preparedness.





George W. Bush's Address to Congress:

U.S Capitol
Washington, D.C
12:10 P.M EST

Mr. Speaker, Mr. President Pro Tempore, members of Congress, and fellow Americans:

In the normal course of events, Presidents come to this chamber to report on the state of the Union. Tonight, no such report is needed. It has already been delivered by the American people.

We have seen the state of our Union in the endurance of rescuers, working past exhaustion. We have seen the unfurling of flags, the lighting of candles, the giving of blood, the saying of prayers -- in English, Hebrew, and Arabic. We have seen the decency of loving and giving people who have made the grief of strangers their own.

On September 11th, enemies of freedom performed an act of terror on the city of New York. Americans have known wars, but for the last 136 years, they were fought on foreign soil. Americans have seen the casualties of war, but never in our own great city. Americans have seen surprise attacks but never one on innocent civilians on a peaceful day in the centre of a big city.

As we entered this new century, the forces of despotism no longer harbor the faces that they used to; they are now a violent extremism that disillusion a peaceful religion. They seek no limit to achieve their misguided goals. They have been gripped with the distorted idea of Jihad, a war where the ends are justified beyond the means, whether that be the slaughter of Christians and jews across the lands, bombing civilians, or removing democratically elected governments.

Americans today ask the questions that have all been in our minds. Is America safe? What shall happen next? My fellow Patriots, I ask you not to worry. As our forefathers have taught us, We shall never back away from a fight.

Tonight, the pain and grief faced by our great nation will give us the strength to pave the future, a future where this world shall be freed from the axis.

This group and its leader, a person named Osama bin Laden, are linked to many other organizations in different countries, including the Egyptian Islamic Jihad and the Islamic Movement of Uzbekistan. There are thousands of these terrorists in more than 60 countries. They are recruited from their own nations and neighborhoods and brought to camps in places like Afghanistan, where they are trained in the tactics of terror. They are sent back to their homes or sent to hide in countries around the world to plot evil and destruction. They will find no refuge, no rest, and no safety from justice.

You do not test the resolve of the United States of America. And soon Osama and his echo chamber will understand why.

Thank you. God Bless America



Structure of the US Cabinet:

1. Vice President

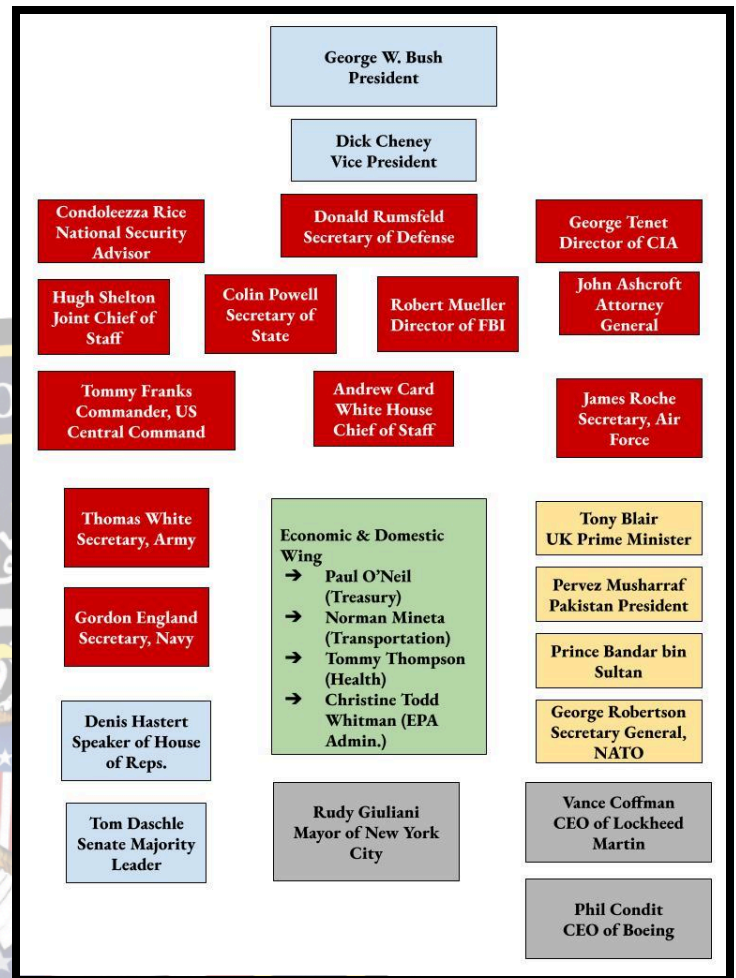
The Vice President of the US Cabinet serves as the deputy head of the cabinet, who advises and aids the president in policy decisions.

2. The Board

The Board presides over key functional wings that are necessary for emergency operations. For any immediate threat response, these members are consulted. It can be referred to as the operational wing.

- National Security Advisor
- Joint Chief of Staff
- Director of the FBI
- Director of the CIA
- Attorney General
- US Central Command
- Secretary, State
- Secretary, Defense
- Secretary, Army
- Secretary, Navy
- Secretary, Air Force
- White House Chief of Staff

Fig: The US Cabinet



3. Economic and Domestic Wing

While the previous collection deals with action, this wing focuses more on the logistical and tangibility of the action being undertaken. The Department of the Treasury, in particular, is responsible for the financial budgeting and balancing that helps sustain the War on Terror. They also deal with domestic issues. The wing includes:

- Secretary, Treasury
- Secretary, Transportation
- Secretary, Health
- EPA Administrator

4. Legislative Representatives:

To keep the interests of the general public in mind, representatives of the legislative segment of the US government are also present in the cabinet. They represent their assemblies and help in passing laws and cementing policy. They are:

- The Speaker of the House of Representatives
- The Senate Majority Leader

5. Foreign Representatives

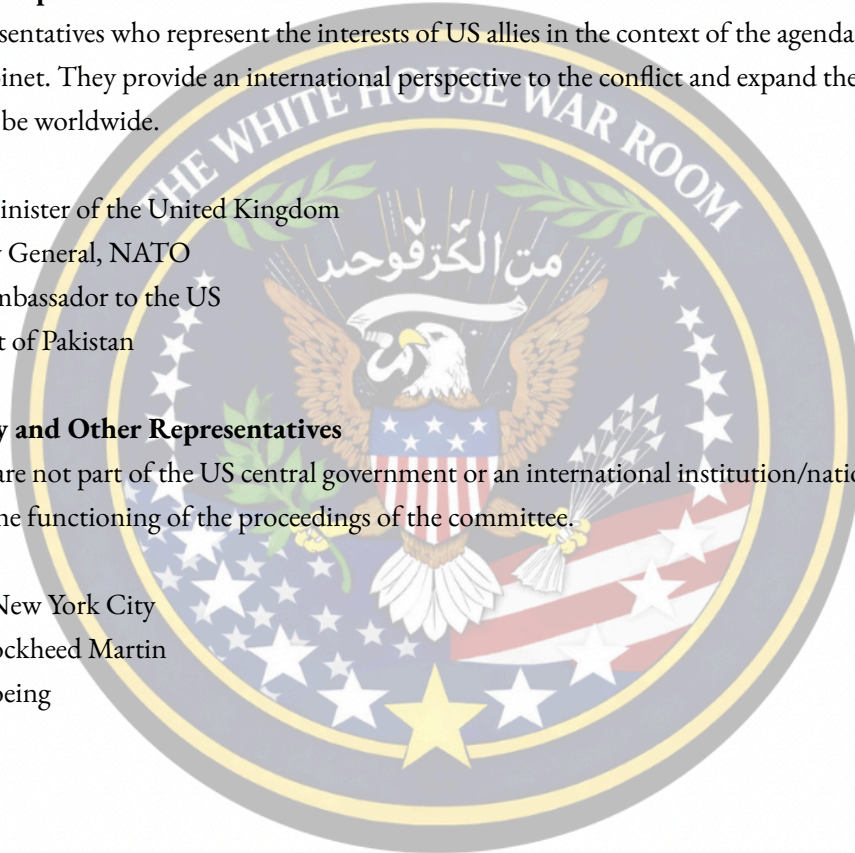
Key foreign representatives who represent the interests of US allies in the context of the agenda at hand are present in the cabinet. They provide an international perspective to the conflict and expand the capabilities of the committee to be worldwide.

- Prime Minister of the United Kingdom
- Secretary General, NATO
- Saudi Ambassador to the US
- President of Pakistan

6. Industry and Other Representatives

These portfolios are not part of the US central government or an international institution/nation, but play key relevant roles in the functioning of the proceedings of the committee.

- Mayor, New York City
- CEO, Lockheed Martin
- CEO, Boeing





Overview of Al Qaeda

Formation and History of Al Qaeda:

To understand the formation of Al Qaeda, it's important to take into account the conditions of Afghanistan during and after the Soviet Invasion of Afghanistan in 1979.

In December 1979, the Soviet Union invaded Afghanistan to support the country's communist government, which was facing growing rebellion and dissent from Afghan groups within the nation. This invasion destabilized an already fragile situation and gave way to a popular insurgency known as the **Afghan Mujahideen**, a coalition of resistance fighters who opposed Soviet influence in Afghanistan. The conflict soon became an important part of the Cold War. Many Afghan refugees moved to neighboring countries like Pakistan and Iran, where refugee camps and border regions became centers for recruiting and organizing fighters for the Afghan Mujahideen.

During this time, an influx of volunteers from around the Muslim world came to Afghanistan, who were eager to aid the Afghan cause against the Russians. They called themselves "**Arab Afghans**," and they were a diverse group. Among them was Osama bin Laden, a Saudi national of considerable means. He used his considerable resources and relationships to fund and assist the insurgents. In the 1980s, bin Laden, with a Palestinian cleric called Abdullah Yusuf Azzam, established the **Maktab al-Khidamat (MAK)**. This group functioned as a support system that facilitated the recruitment of volunteers, secured funding for the volunteers, and arranged travel and training for foreign fighters in Afghanistan. The MAK made connections between militants from different nations and formed networks that extended well beyond Afghanistan.

By this time, Afghanistan was full of militants, volunteers, and ideological supporters who were convinced armed struggle was the only way to advance their Islamic causes. During the Soviet invasion, training camps were established, financial support systems for these fighters were developed, and jihadists from different regions gained combat experience while building relationships with one another. These links forged a transnational network, one that could persist long after the fighting ceased. By the late 1980s, with Soviet troops poised to leave Afghanistan, bin Laden and a few of his inner circle began contemplating the network's future. They discussed how it might be maintained and repurposed to aid Islamist movements embroiled in other global struggles.

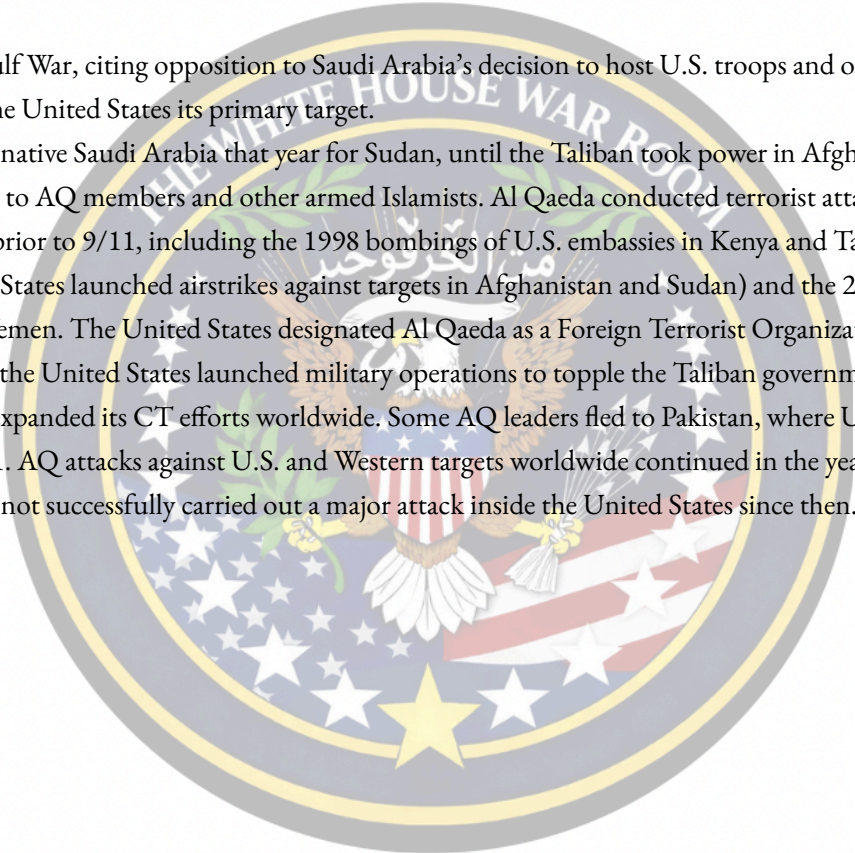
In 1988, bin Laden formally established **Al-Qaeda**, which translates to "**the base**". Osama bin Laden established Al Qaeda from a network of Arab and other foreign veterans of the U.S.- backed Afghan insurgency against the USSR, to support extremist Islamist causes around the world. Al-Qaeda's history began with the goal to serve as a logistical network to support Muslims fighting against the Soviet Union during the Afghan War,

with international member recruitments.

When Soviet forces withdrew from Afghanistan in 1989, the immediate conflict came to an end, but the country remained politically unstable and deeply divided. Many of the fighters kept the connections they had formed during the conflict. The networks built during the war continued to exist and evolve in the years that followed. As a result, Al-Qaeda emerged not simply as the creation of one individual, but as a product of the larger political, military, and ideological environment that developed during the Soviet–Afghan War and the international mobilization that surrounded it.

After the 1991 Gulf War, citing opposition to Saudi Arabia’s decision to host U.S. troops and other grievances, the group made the United States its primary target.

Bin Laden left his native Saudi Arabia that year for Sudan, until the Taliban took power in Afghanistan in 1996 and offered refuge to AQ members and other armed Islamists. Al Qaeda conducted terrorist attacks against U.S. and allied targets prior to 9/11, including the 1998 bombings of U.S. embassies in Kenya and Tanzania (after which the United States launched airstrikes against targets in Afghanistan and Sudan) and the 2000 attack on the USS Cole in Yemen. The United States designated Al Qaeda as a Foreign Terrorist Organization (FTO) in 1999. After 9/11, the United States launched military operations to topple the Taliban government in Afghanistan and expanded its CT efforts worldwide. Some AQ leaders fled to Pakistan, where U.S. forces killed Bin Laden in 2011. AQ attacks against U.S. and Western targets worldwide continued in the years after 9/11, but the group has not successfully carried out a major attack inside the United States since then.



Doctrine and Ideology:

Al-Qaeda's ideological framework was largely formed during the Soviet–Afghan War of the 1980s. The shared experience of war, along with exposure to militant, extremist, and religious ideas, helped create the belief that armed struggle to protect Muslim lands was a religious duty. Leaders like Osama bin Laden and Abdullah Azzam spread these ideas through recruitment, speeches, and publications, which helped to build the ideological foundation that later became associated with Al-Qaeda.

Al-Qaeda's fundamental ideological principles center on several key tenets:

1. **Jihad:** A cornerstone of Al-Qaeda's ideology is the conviction that armed conflict, or "jihad," is essential for safeguarding Muslim populations and for expelling foreign presence from territories they deem part of the Islamic world. It believes that warfare is a religious duty, and it is more than just political differences.
2. **No "Outside" Influence:** Al-Qaeda's doctrine states that the Muslim world has been weakened by the United States, Israel, Shiite Muslims, and Islamic heretics. These are its 4 principal enemies. According to this perspective, the political, military, and cultural influence of these 4 enemies is viewed as a major cause of instability and injustice in Muslim societies and harms their fundamental existence.
3. **Rejection of Existing Governments:** The group believes that many governments in Muslim-majority countries lack legitimacy because they don't follow Al-Qaeda's interpretation of Islamic law and governance. As a result, the members of Al-Qaeda believe that these governments should be replaced with systems based on their understanding of Islamic political authority, such as the Sharia and clerical rule.
4. **Global Struggle:** Unlike many earlier militant movements that focused on political change within a single country, Al-Qaeda promotes the idea of a global struggle. It views wars involving Muslims in different regions as connected issues and seeks to unite supporters across national borders into a broader caliphate.
5. **Long-Term Conflict Strategy:** Al-Qaeda's ideology places more emphasis on protracted warfare than on swift political triumphs. The group's belief, which was influenced in part by the sense of triumph during the Soviet withdrawal from Afghanistan, is that sustained resistance can progressively weaken its adversaries.
6. **Importance of Propaganda and Recruitment:** Another important part of Al-Qaeda's doctrine is spreading its ideological message. Al-Qaeda has used written statements, recorded messages, and online

media to promote its ideas, recruit more supporters, and to encourage other militant groups or individuals to adopt similar beliefs and actions.

The doctrine of Al Qaeda focuses on and establishes the United States, Jews, and its allies as the root rot and enemy of the Islamic world. It urges its members to destroy and finish American imperialism and spread Islamic Sharia over the entire world.



Internal Structure of Al Qaeda:

The internal structure of Al Qaeda is a rigid power structure that governs and controls the entire Al Qaeda terror network across the globe. While all members of Al Qaeda follow the same ideology, they each play different roles in the internal functioning of the group.

- **Emir (Supreme Leader):** The **Emir** was the highest authority in Al Qaeda. This position is held by **Osama bin Laden**. As the organization's symbolic and ideological leader, the Emir establishes Al Qaeda's overarching strategy and objectives, authorizes significant decisions, and supervises alliances with other militant organizations.
- **Deputy Emir:** The Deputy Emir supports the Emir in his leadership responsibilities and takes action on his behalf when needed. The deputy makes sure that strategic decisions are carried out throughout the company and assists in coordinating communication between senior leaders. The position is occupied by Ayman al-Zawahiri.
- **Military Commanders:** Al Qaeda's military commanders are in charge of organizing operations, supervising militant activities, and training fighters. They oversee training facilities in Afghanistan and manage fighters who have joined the network from other nations. They serve as the central Al Qaeda organization's operational core.
- **Finance:** Certain members of Al Qaeda manage the financial aspect of running the terror group. This includes **funding, donations, and distribution of resources** within. This ensures money is available for training camps, recruitment, logistics, and maintaining networks of operatives.
- **Religious/Legal Scholars:** It maintains a group of clerics and theoreticians who provide **religious justification and ideological guidance** for the terror group's actions as well as the necessity of its existence. It helps shape the group's doctrine and produces statements and declarations that supplement and support its beliefs.
- **Media and Propaganda:** This is a new and particularly dangerous wing of Al Qaeda. It is responsible for **spreading Al-Qaeda's message** to the world by means of the internet. This varies from issuing public statements and videos to written materials. This branch helps recruit supporters and promote the group's ideology internationally. It threatens a spread of jihadist ideals at a rate never seen before.

- **Regional Cells and Field Commanders:** Smaller operational cells and regional leaders fall under the Emir's central leadership and various military commanders. These groups conduct operations in different countries or regions while staying connected to the central leadership. They are responsible for managing and operating the various Al Qaeda camps.

Previous Attacks:

Al Qaeda conducted terrorist attacks against U.S. and allied targets prior to 9/11. These are some of the major previous attacks

1. **Aden Hotel Bombings (Yemen):** One hundred U.S. servicemen had just left the Gold Mohur Hotel, on their way to duty in Somalia, when the bomb hit. It killed two people in the hotel and seriously wounded four tourists. Two suspects reportedly had 23 bombs, two antitank mines, dynamite, and machine guns.
2. **World Trade Center Bombing (United States):** terrorist attack in New York City on February 26, 1993, in which a truck bomb exploded in a basement-level parking garage under the World Trade Center complex. Six people were killed, and more than 1,000 were injured in what was at that time the deadliest act of terrorism perpetrated on U.S. soil.
3. **Riyadh Bombing (Saudi Arabia):** The 2003 Riyadh compound bombings were a series of coordinated suicide terrorist attacks on May 12, 2003, targeting residential compounds for Westerners in Riyadh, Saudi Arabia, by Al-Qaeda. The bombings killed 39 people (including 9 bombers) and wounded over 160, largely targeting foreign nationals to disrupt the Saudi kingdom
4. **Khobar Towers Bombing (Saudi Arabia):** The Khobar Towers bombing was an attack on part of a housing complex in the city of Khobar, Saudi Arabia, near the national oil company headquarters of Dhahran and nearby King Abdulaziz Air Base.
5. **U.S. Embassy Bombings (Kenya and Tanzania):** On August 7, 1998, nearly simultaneous bombs blew up in front of the American embassies in Nairobi, Kenya, and Dar es Salaam, Tanzania, in Africa. 224 people died in the blasts, including 12 Americans, and more than 4,500 people were wounded.
6. **USS Cole Bombing (Yemen):** The USS Cole bombing was a suicide attack by al-Qaeda against USS Cole, a guided missile destroyer of the United States Navy, on 12 October 2000, while it was being refueled in Yemen's Aden harbor.



Military Arsenal:

Bush Cabinet Arms :

The Bush Cabinet had access to a wide range of arms and artillery before 9/11, primarily focused on offensive capabilities. After 9/11, there was a significant shift toward strengthening defensive systems, intelligence operations, and carrier-based capabilities. These military resources played a crucial role in shaping and executing the War on Terror.

- Fighter Jets
- F-15 Eagle
- Used for homeland defense (NORAD patrols after 9/11)
- F-16 Fighting Falcon
Interception + ground attack missions
- F/A-18 Hornet
Used in Afghanistan from aircraft carriers
- B-52 Stratofortress
Dropped heavy bomb loads on Taliban/Al-Qaeda
- B-1B Lancer
Precision strikes with JDAMs
- B-2 Spirit
Used for early stealth strikes in Afghanistan
- UH-60 Black Hawk
Troop transport, medevac
- AH-64 Apache
- Close air support, anti-tank missions
- CH-47 Chinook
Transporting troops, artillery, and supplies



Infantry Weapons

- M4 Carbine
Primary weapon for soldiers
- M16 Rifle
Still used early in the war
- --M249 SAW



- –M240 Machine Gun
- –M9 Pistol

Anti-Tank / Heavy Weapons

- FGM-148 Javelin
- –AT4
- M777 Howitzer
Lightweight, widely used in Afghanistan
- M109 Paladin
Armored mobile artillery



Rocket Artillery

- M270 MLRS
Fires guided rockets over long distances
- M142 HIMARS
Became crucial later in the War on Terror
- Armored Vehicles
- M1 Abrams
Used mainly in Iraq (less in Afghanistan)
- –M2 Bradley
- –Stryker
- –Humvee
MRAP
Introduced later to counter IEDs

Navy

- Nimitz-class aircraft carrier
Base for air operations in Afghanistan

- Arleigh Burke-class destroyer
Equipped with cruise missiles

Naval Weapons

- Tomahawk Cruise Missile
Used in early strikes (Operation Enduring Freedom)

Drones

- MQ-1 Predator
Surveillance + targeted strikes
- MQ-9 Reaper
More advanced, heavily armed

Intelligence & Surveillance

- Satellites (GPS-guided warfare)
- AWACS aircraft:
- E-3 Sentry
- Night vision & thermal imaging (key in Afghanistan)



Special Forces Equipment

Used by: Navy SEALs, Delta Force

Equipment included:

- Suppressed weapons
- *Advanced communication gear*

- *Laser-guided targeting system*

Al Qaeda Weapons :

Al-Qaeda did not rely on a formal military arsenal. Most weapons were obtained through black markets, captured stockpiles, or smuggling networks. Their most effective tools were not heavy artillery but small arms and explosives, especially IEDs, which allowed them to fight stronger militaries using guerrilla and asymmetric warfare tactics.

- AK-47

The most commonly used rifle. It is reliable, easy to use, and widely available, making it ideal for guerrilla warfare and ambushes.

- AK-74

A more modern version of the AK-47 with better accuracy and lighter recoil, used by more trained fighters.

- PK Machine Gun

Provides continuous firepower. Used in ambushes and defensive positions to suppress enemy forces.

- Pistols

Used for close-range combat and assassinations. Easy to conceal and useful in covert operations.

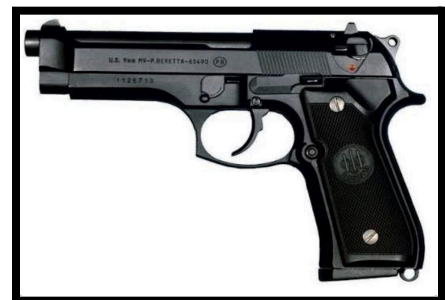
- Sniper rifles

Used in limited numbers to target specific individuals, like officers. Effective in slowing enemy movement.

- Explosives and Tactical Weapons

- Improvised Explosive Devices (IEDs)

Homemade bombs are the most important weapon used.



They were cheap, adaptable, and highly effective against military vehicles and civilians.

- Car bombs

Vehicles packed with explosives. Used for large-scale attacks in cities and against infrastructure.

- Suicide bomb vests

Worn by attackers to detonate in crowded or strategic locations. Created a strong psychological impact and fear.

- Grenades

Hand-thrown explosives used in close combat and urban fighting. Simple but effective in confined spaces.

- Rocket and Anti-Armor Weapons

- RPG-7

A portable launcher used against vehicles and buildings. Easy to operate and widely available.

- Anti-tank weapons (limited use)

Occasionally used when available, mainly against armored targets, though not widely maintained or supplied.

- Artillery and Heavy-Type Support (Limited and Irregular)

- Mortars (60mm, 82mm)

Used for indirect fire over distances. Allowed attacks on bases or positions without direct confrontation.

- Captured artillery pieces

Sometimes seized in conflict zones like Afghanistan or Syria. Use was limited due to lack of training and logistics.

- Anti-aircraft guns (e.g., ZU-23-2)

Used mainly against ground targets despite being designed for aircraft. Mounted on vehicles for mobility.

- MANPADS (portable anti-air missiles)

Rare and difficult to maintain. Occasionally used against low-flying aircraft but not a consistent capability.

- Vehicles and Mobility-Based Weapons

- Technical vehicles (pickup trucks with mounted guns)

Used for fast movement and surprise attacks. Allowed hit-and-run tactics in deserts and urban areas.

- Captured armored vehicles

Sometimes acquired in later conflicts, especially in Iraq and Syria. Use was inconsistent and dependent on availability.

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